

Griffin Naess, RHP, Cal Poly

Metrics

FB: 88.6/20.1 IVB/12.0 HB/-5.26 VAA/6.46 relH/6.02 ext/37.0% zone/45.6% usage/2170 rpm

CB: 73.6/-18.3 IVB/-14.4 HB/-11.24 VAA/30.0% zone/16.9% usage/2830 rpm

SL: 80.4/3.1 IVB/-1.1 HB/-8.42 VAA/17.0% zone/8.0% usage/2540 rpm

CH: 76.0/7.9 IVB/19.7 HB/-8.83 VAA/26.8% zone/29.5% usage/2090 rpm

Write-Up

Naess is a physical 6-foot-6 right-hander whose success is built around movement diversity, deception, and one of the more unique velocity separation profiles in the dataset. None of the offerings overwhelm hitters with velocity, but the combination of a heavily fading changeup, a massive curveball, and a riding fastball creates difficult swing decisions throughout an at-bat. The profile lacks a true power pitch, though the arsenal works together well enough to project professional starter utility.

The FB features outstanding raw shape, generating more than 20 inches of IVB alongside 12 inches of HB. Despite the movement profile, the pitch enters the zone with a relatively steep -5.26° VAA, limiting how much the ride ultimately plays against hitters. The velocity is well below professional average, forcing the pitch to rely heavily on command and sequencing. The results were solid but not overwhelming, producing a 14.6% whiff rate and 28.6% CSW. The shape is better than the velocity, though the overall projection remains capped by the lack of fastball power. 40/45+ pitch.

The CB is a massive downer with exceptional depth and sweep. Generating over 18 inches of drop and 14 inches of gloveside movement, the pitch creates one of the most dramatic movement profiles in the report. The shape is impressive, though the command remains inconsistent as evidenced by the 30% zone rate. Even with those command limitations, hitters struggled to square it up and the pitch generated strong results throughout the season. The shape alone gives the pitch professional utility. 50/55+ pitch.

The SL is used sparingly and functions primarily as a change-of-look offering. The shape is distinct from the curveball, allowing Naess to present hitters with another movement profile, but the limited

usage and inconsistent strike throwing make projection difficult. The underlying results were encouraging, though the pitch presently profiles as more of a complementary offering than a carrying weapon. 40/45+ pitch.

The CH is the best pitch in the arsenal. Featuring nearly 20 inches of HB and substantial velocity separation off the FB, the pitch consistently generated uncomfortable swing decisions from hitters on both sides of the plate. The results support the shape, with a 38.6% chase rate, 39.9% whiff rate, and 18.6% SwStr rate. Naess showed confidence throwing the pitch regularly and it served as the primary weapon in the repertoire. While the velocity is modest, the combination of movement and deception allows the pitch to project as a legitimate professional out pitch. 55/60+ pitch.